MONTHLY UPDATE

Rwanda: monthly update, September – October 2026

Edition of 2026-10-16 · compiled by Claude Opus from the documents in the Corpus repository

> *Developments reported in sources published between the beginning of last month and today, grouped by story, oldest first.*

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ICT INFRASTRUCTURE
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DIGITALISATION
Digitalisation of sub-national government · Rural digital data capture

TECHNOLOGY
AI

CAPACITY
Literacy · Training and skills

INCLUSION
Access to services · Digital divides

DATA
National statistics

GEOPOLITICS
India activities

Governance

Regional collaboration

FOREIGN GOVERNMENT DELEGATIONS STUDYING THE E-GOVERNMENT MODEL

- **E-gouvernance : Gabon, Guinée, Liberia… le Rwanda attire les administrations africaines venues étudier son modèle numérique** — Digital Business Africa, 1 September 2026 GABON GUINEA LIBERIA

  Eight delegations from seven countries in one week; IremboGov at 248 services, certificates near tripled.

INTERNATIONAL DECLARATION ON SPACE-BASED SCIENTIFIC DATA

- **International declaration on space-based scientific data.** — Élysée, 10 September 2026 ANGOLA DRC MADAGASCAR MAURITIUS TUNISIA GLOBAL

49 signatory states plus ESA, among them Angola, DR Congo, Madagascar, Mauritius, Rwanda, Tunisia; open licences, FAIR.

NATIONAL POSITION ON ORBITAL AND RADIO-FREQUENCY ACCESS

- **Kagame Seeks Removal of Technology Export Restrictions to Africa** — KT Press, 10 September 2026 AFRICA

  Rwanda's president warned at the first International Space Summit in Paris that African countries risk losing access to valuable orbital and radio-frequency resources as the global space industry expands, and urged the continent to coordinate its interests and take a stronger voice in rule-setting. He said Africa should be a full participant in the sector rather than only a consumer of satellite services, and sought the removal of technology export restrictions.

HOSTING OF THE SEVENTH UN WORLD DATA FORUM, 2028

- **Rwanda Has Been Selected as Africa's Second UN World Data Forum Host** — RADIOTV10, 22 September 2026

  Chosen 21 Sept 2026 by UN High-level Group; seventh edition, Q4 2028, first in Africa since Cape Town 2017.

Standards

STANDARDS TECHNICAL COOPERATION AGREEMENT WITH ZAMBIA

- **Zambia, Rwanda sign technical cooperation agreement to harmonise standards** — Zambia Monitor, 3 September 2026 ZAMBIA

  ZABS-RSB deal signed at the 32nd ARSO Assembly covers mutual recognition of conformity results.

Finance

MoUs and other agreements

SEMICONDUCTOR DESIGN SKILLS MEMORANDUM WITH CHIPMANGO

- **Rwanda Signs MoU With ChipMango to Build Local Semiconductor Design Skills** — Tech Africa News, 22 September 2026

  Rwanda's Ministry of ICT and Innovation signed a memorandum of understanding with ChipMango to build local semiconductor design skills. It followed talks between Minister of State Yves Iradukunda and the company on a national chip-design talent pipeline.

DIGITAL TRANSFORMATION MEMORANDUM WITH JORDAN

- **Rwanda, Jordan sign agreement on cooperation in digital transformation** — The New Times, 24 September 2026

  MoU signed 23 Sept 2026 at UNGA 81; Jordan's Super App and digital public services the model; no sum stated.

- **Le Rwanda et la Jordanie ouvrent une coopération sur l'IA, l'identité numérique et les services publics** — wearetech.africa, 25 September 2026

  Rwanda and Jordan signed a memorandum of understanding on ICT cooperation on the sidelines of UNGA81 on 24 September, between Rwanda's ICT minister Paula Ingabire and Jordan's digital economy minister Sami Smeirat. It covers sharing experience in digital public services, digital identity and AI and identifying joint projects.

New investments

IDA ADDITIONAL FINANCING FOR A DIGITAL-ADOPTION PROJECT

- **Cabinet Meeting: Rwanda appoints new officials at Rwanda FDA, Justice Ministry and other institutions - AE News** — AE News, 19 September 2026

  Cabinet clears a bill to ratify IDA additional financing for digital adoption, loan signed 11 July 2026.

- **Rwanda Secures $19 Million to Extend Government Digitalization Drive** — wearetech.africa, 9 October 2026

  Rwanda's parliament ratified EUR 17 million of World Bank financing for digital identity, public data management and cybersecurity, restoring part of US$20 million cut from the project in 2024. Delays to the government data hub have pushed the project's deadline to June 2028.

ICT Infrastructure

Connectivity

CROSS-BORDER TERRESTRIAL FIBRE ROUTE

- **Paratus expands East Africa connectivity ahead of ITW Africa** — TechTrendsKE, 9 September 2026 DRC UGANDA KENYA

  Paratus said its 2,000km Goma-to-Mombasa terrestrial fibre route is live and carrying traffic, announced at the ITW and Datacloud Africa conference in Nairobi. The route links eastern DRC to the Kenyan coast through Kigali, Kampala and Nairobi, with access to subsea capacity landing at Mombasa. Starlink services have launched in Uganda alongside it, and the company is introducing a Layer 2 connectivity service over low-earth-orbit satellite for the East African market.

Data Storage

SHARED GOVERNMENT DATA HUB AND INTEROPERABILITY PLATFORM

- **Africa needs to take charge of its digital health systems, says minister** — The New Times, 2 October 2026

  Iradukunda on donor-funded health systems; NISR, MINICT, RISA data roles; Shared Government Data Hub into implementation.

Technical Capacity

SOVEREIGN AI COMPUTE

- **Local AI compute infrastructure in Africa: Lessons from six country-hosted deployments on governance and effective use** — United Nations Development Programme (UNDP), Regional Bureau for Africa, 17 September 2026 KENYA MALAWI SOUTH AFRICA TOGO ZAMBIA AFRICA

  Six-country UNDP review: 21 AI applications identified, and usable data the weakest link, not the GPUs.

Cybersecurity

REPORTED DIGITAL PAYMENT FRAUD CASES

- **Digital Payments Hit 3.1Billion, Fraud Complaints Drop 30%** — Taarifa Rwanda, 4 October 2026

  Rwanda's prime minister said reported financial fraud complaints fell by about 30% in the second quarter of 2026 from 4,128 a year earlier. Digital transactions rose from about 256 million in 2017 to 3.1 billion in 2025, and he said phone-based fraud remains a problem.

- **Rwanda cyber fraud falls 30%, but fund recovery remains low** — IGIHE, 8 October 2026

  Only 3.6% of Q2 2026 fraud losses recovered; cases down to 2,879, value Rwf471m.

DPI

Data Exchange

AFRICA ACCELERATOR FOR DIGITAL PUBLIC INFRASTRUCTURE (AA4DPI)

- **CDPI on its session at the Africa Accelerator for Digital Public Infrastructure, 2–3 September 2026** — Centre for Digital Public Infrastructure (CDPI), 3 September 2026 ETHIOPIA MALAWI SIERRA LEONE ZAMBIA

  Two-day accelerator session, 2–3 Sept 2026: delegations from Ethiopia, Malawi, Rwanda, Sierra Leone, Zambia.

- **Africa Accelerator for Digital Public Infrastructure (AA4DPI)** — United Nations Development Programme, 8 September 2026 AFRICA

  UNDP has published the standing description of its Africa Accelerator for Digital Public Infrastructure, led jointly by the Regional Bureau for Africa and the Digital and AI Hub, which supports countries to assess digital readiness, strengthen governance, build implementation capacity and develop investment-ready programmes across digital identity, digital payments and data exchange. Its first published cohort session ran on 2 and 3 September with delegations from Ethiopia, Malawi, Rwanda, Sierra Leone and Zambia; no budget, duration or deliverable set is published for the accelerator itself.

- **UNDP's AA4DPI Programme Deepens South-South Cooperation on Digital Public Infrastructure** — United Nations Development Programme (UNDP), 8 September 2026 ETHIOPIA MALAWI SIERRA LEONE ZAMBIA AFRICA

  Delegations from Ethiopia, Malawi, Rwanda, Sierra Leone and Zambia, with African Union representatives, concluded a two-week South-South learning mission to India on digital public infrastructure. Convened under UNDP's newly launched Africa Accelerator for Digital Public Infrastructure, it took delegates through New Delhi, Pune and Bengaluru to examine India's digital identity, payment and data exchange systems.

MASTERKEY DIGITAL SKILLS AND WORK WALLET

- **Kenyan President Ruto names Ghana among first countries for portable skills programme** — Graphic Online, 22 September 2026 KENYA GHANA

  Verifiable skills-and-work wallet; Ghana, Rwanda, Kenya in phase one, 150,000 placements; Kenya's wallet via eCitizen.

Digital Identity and CRVS

DIGITAL IDENTITY ENROLMENT

- **Over 10 million Rwandans registered for digital ID** — Umunota, 16 September 2026

  NIDA puts biometric capture past 10m people in 27 of 30 districts as Rusizi registration opens.

- **NIDA temporarily suspends photography exercise for e-IDs** — Ukweli Times, 8 October 2026

  Rwanda's identification agency suspended the photography exercise for the digital identity card and gave no date for resuming it. Pre-enrolment through Irembo continues, and residents are asked to correct civil-registration details first.

Digital Payments and Fintech

EKASH INSTANT TRANSFER SERVICE

- **Rwanda’s New eKash Payment System Wins Praise, But Users Report Lingering Transfer Glitches** — RADIOTV10, 2 September 2026

10.5m transactions and RWF 960bn since the 14 July 2026 launch, at a 98.6% success rate.

- **BNR Moves to Tackle Delayed eKash Transfers** — KT Press, 9 October 2026

  Rwanda's central bank said it is working with financial institutions on delayed and failed transfers on the national payment switch, with rejections below 2% by September. Active accounts rose from 2.03 million to 10.3 million in a year.

CENTRAL BANK NATIONAL CASHLESS CAMPAIGN

- **Central Bank Takes Aim at Cash as 92% Still Rely on It** — KT Press, 10 September 2026

  85.3% hold a digital account but 92% still pay cash; #TwagiyeKashiresi tours the districts.

VALUE ADDED TAX ORDER ON ONLINE SERVICES

- **Rwanda's online VAT regime raises compliance questions early** — The New Times, 15 September 2026

  Order 004/26/10/TC: no portal yet, bank withholding by default, no reverse charge, texts diverge.

BANK OF KIGALI DIRECT PARTICIPATION IN CHINA'S CROSS-BORDER INTERBANK PAYMENT SYSTEM

- **Bank of Kigali Joins China's Cross-Border Payments System, First in This Region** — KT Press, 22 September 2026

  Direct CIPS participant; agreement signed in Xiamen 2026-09-08; RMB settlement with Rwanda's largest trading partner.

DIGITAL AGRICULTURAL LENDING PLATFORM

- **Rwanda is Testing Digital Platform to Get Small Farmers Loans in 48 Hours - KT PRESS** — KT Press, 8 October 2026

  Rwanda's central bank is piloting a digital agricultural lending platform meant to cut farmers' wait for a loan from five to seven weeks to under 48 hours. The six-month pilot began in September 2026 with two microfinance institutions and two banks; a national rollout is planned for 2027.

GHANA-RWANDA CROSS-BORDER PAYMENT INTEROPERABILITY PILOT

- **Bank of Ghana pilots digital cross-border payments with Rwanda, Nigeria** — Ghana News Agency, 13 October 2026 GHANA NIGERIA

  CBDC, stablecoin and wallet pilots with Rwanda and Nigeria; PAPSS opened to wallets; passporting offered to 10+ states.

- **Ghana, Rwanda, Nigeria test new cross-border digital payment systems** — Graphic Online, 14 October 2026 GHANA NIGERIA

  Bank of Ghana Governor Johnson Asiama said on 13 October that the bank is testing cross-border payment interoperability with Rwanda and Nigeria across CBDCs, stablecoins, bank accounts and mobile wallets, with the aim of moving to live services on rails such as PAPSS. He said Ghana's mobile money transactions passed one billion in a month for the first time in August 2026, worth GH¢519 billion, and reported fraud cases rose 48% in 2025.

Registries

PHONE-BASED COMMUNITY DEATH NOTIFICATION

- **To Make Every Life Count, Count Every Life** — LinkedIn (Tom Frieden), 28 September 2026

> A former head of the US disease-control agency describes Rwanda's phone-based death notification, in which village leaders report each community death with the deceased's national ID number, reaching the outbreak command centre within minutes. Rolled out nationwide in spring 2026, it logged about 10,000 community deaths in its first months, against a target of 70% of community deaths this year.

Sectoral management information systems

> INTEGRATED ELECTRONIC CASE MANAGEMENT SYSTEM

- **Emerging crimes, digital justice: What's ahead in new judicial year** — The New Times, 5 September 2026

  2026/27 judicial year to push digital justice services, alternative dispute resolution and emerging-crime capacity.

> IREMBO MEDI PATIENT HEALTH PLATFORM

- **Five Years On, Rwanda Is Leading the Edge of Digital Health in Africa** — KT Press, 30 September 2026

  Irembo Medi brings patients onto the national service platform; NHIC wants health data to flow back to care workers.

Other GovTech and e-Gov

> PUBLIC SERVICES CARRIED BY THE NATIONAL E-GOVERNMENT PLATFORM

- **E-gouvernance : Gabon, Guinée, Liberia… le Rwanda attire les administrations africaines venues étudier son modèle numérique** — Digital Business Africa, 1 September 2026 GABON GUINEA LIBERIA

  Summarised under Regional collaboration.

Digitalisation

Digitalisation of sub-national government

> PUBLIC ARGUMENT ON DIGITAL DELIVERY IN DECENTRALISATION

- **Never Again Rwanda calls for stronger powers at cell level, more decentralised services** — The New Times, 17 September 2026

  A civil-society organisation called for stronger powers at cell level and more decentralised services, putting 44 per cent of 522 public services as decentralised. The local government ministry is stated to be digitalising local government services and reviewing the capacity of the cell, the lowest administrative level.

> SHARE OF PUBLIC SERVICES DECENTRALISED

- **Never Again Rwanda calls for stronger powers at cell level, more decentralised services** — The New Times, 17 September 2026

  Summarised under Digitalisation of sub-national government.

Rural digital data capture

> SOLAR CONNECTIVITY AND POWER UNITS FOR HEALTH POSTS

- **Inside a new infrastructure layer boosting Rwanda's digital health expansion** — IGIHE, 8 October 2026

  Solar Wi-Fi and power units at 65 health posts in 21 districts with MoH and Gavi; target 150.

Technology

AI

ARTIFICIAL-INTELLIGENCE AGRICULTURAL ADVISORY FOR SMALLHOLDER FARMERS

- **Here Is Our AI Plan to Reach 2.5 Million Rwandan Farmers - KT PRESS** — KT PRESS, 2 September 2026

  Ingabire's Kigali roundtable text: e-Soko, Smart Nkunganire's 1.5m farmers, and the Tunga voice assistant.

REGIONAL HIGHER-EDUCATION QUALITY ASSURANCE UNDER AI

- **EA Universities Rethink Quality as AI Puts Degrees to a New Test** — KT Press, 7 September 2026 EAST AFRICA

  Rwanda's education minister opens the 15th East African Higher Education Quality Assurance Network forum on AI.

SOVEREIGN AI COMPUTE OR NATIONAL MODEL

- **Local AI compute infrastructure in Africa: Lessons from six country-hosted deployments on governance and effective use** — United Nations Development Programme (UNDP), Regional Bureau for Africa, 17 September 2026 KENYA MALAWI SOUTH AFRICA TOGO ZAMBIA AFRICA

  Summarised under Technical Capacity.

STATISTICS INSTITUTE'S AI MODEL FOR CODING SURVEY RESPONSES

- **Award-winner Ngirinshuti on an AI model that serves Rwanda's statistical analysis** — Cenfri, 1 October 2026

  NISR model auto-coded 96% of test records across ISIC, ISCO, ISCED; ITU Innovate for Impact award; field app pending.

Capacity

Literacy

DIGITAL PARENTING AND ONLINE SAFETY TRAINING

- **Empowering Parents in Rwanda Through Digital Literacy Training** — Internet Society, 4 September 2026

  ISOC Rwanda Chapter trained 50 parents and teachers in Karongi on online safety and Irembo e-services.

Training and skills

CYBERSECURITY COURSES IN TECHNICAL AND VOCATIONAL EDUCATION

- **Rwanda takes cybersecurity to TVET schools as first 24 teachers complete training** — The New Times, 9 September 2026

  First cohort of 24 TVET teachers completes a 10-day training-of-trainers programme to roll out cybersecurity courses.

Inclusion

Access to services

BUSINESS OBSTACLES ALERT PLATFORM

- **RDB mulls new platform for businesses to report service delivery obstacles** — The New Times, 8 October 2026

> Planned digital channel to report post-registration obstacles; 95% of 250,000+ services on time since January.

Digital divides

> PROJECTED EFFECT OF AFFORDABILITY AND SKILLS REFORMS ON MOBILE INTERNET USE

- **Digital Reforms Could Connect Over 1 Million More People to Mobile Internet in Rwanda, GSMA Finds** — GSMA, 17 September 2026

  A GSMA report projects that more than a million additional people in Rwanda could be using mobile internet by 2031 if smartphones are made more affordable and digital services more relevant to everyday life. It names lower-income and rural households as the group the reforms would reach.

> GENDANA KONTI WOMEN'S MOBILE-FINANCE CAMPAIGN

- **Abagore barenga 600,000 batangiye gukoresha serivisi z'imari kuri telefoni nyuma yo kumenya ibanga ryayo - Gate of Wise** — Gate of Wise, 27 September 2026

  BNR Gendana Konti campaign: 615,000 women onboarded to mobile finance against 150,000 target; 72% vs 81% gap.

Data

National statistics

> HIGHER EDUCATION PERFORMANCE MEASUREMENT FRAMEWORK

- **Rwanda Building Data-Driven Framework to Measure Quality of Higher Education** — Taarifa Rwanda, 16 September 2026

  HEC builds a national framework to capture and publish standardised data on universities and graduates.

> UN REGIONAL HUB FOR BIG DATA AND DATA SCIENCE IN AFRICA

- **Rwanda Has Been Selected as Africa's Second UN World Data Forum Host** — RADIOTV10, 22 September 2026

  Summarised under Regional collaboration.

Geopolitics

India activities

> INDIA DIGITAL PUBLIC INFRASTRUCTURE LEARNING MISSION

- **Karnataka Hosts African Union, Five African Nations For Digital Public Infrastructure Exposure Visit** — The Bengaluru Live, 1 September 2026 ETHIOPIA MALAWI SIERRA LEONE ZAMBIA

  AU plus Ethiopia, Malawi, Rwanda, Sierra Leone and Zambia study Karnataka DPI; UNDP-supported.

- **African Delegations Explore India's Digital Public Infrastructure During UNDP Learning Mission** — Youth Village Zambia, 2 September 2026 ZAMBIA ETHIOPIA MALAWI SIERRA LEONE

  Five African delegations tour Aadhaar, UPI and DigiLocker on a UNDP South-South mission.

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